LATER GATOR

SPRINT RETROSPECTIVE

PREPARED FOR

CEN3031 – Introduction to Software Engineering
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PREPARED BY

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Cover image created with ChatGPT (OpenAI).

Insights Activity

During our Sprint Retrospective, Team Later Gator reflected on what went well, what could improve, and what lessons we learned. Using the insights activity, we collaboratively generated ideas about both technical and teamwork-related experiences from the sprint.

Event Timeline

We began by constructing a visual timeline of key sprint events. Each member added sticky notes to mark successes, challenges, and milestones throughout the development cycle. This helped the team recognize recurring patterns (as seen below the timeline in Figure 1, below) and points where workflow could improve.

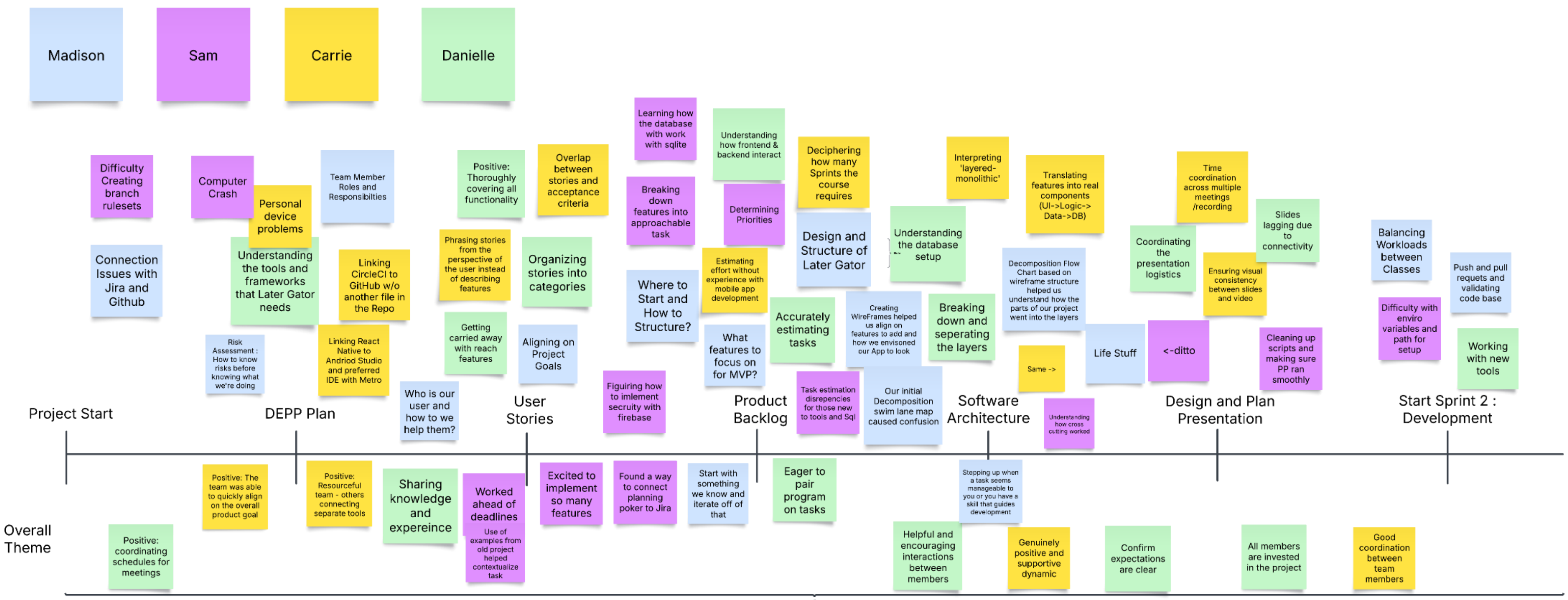

Figure 1: Team Later Gator visualizing key sprint events using a timeline of successes, challenges, and milestones.

Although we did not include an "Emotions Seismograph," the team still took time to discuss our emotional highs and lows throughout the sprint. We agreed that being part of this team feels like a welcome relief from other pressures in our lives. Even with the uncertainty of whether we will produce a fully working prototype, that uncertainty has not discouraged us, it is motivating. The shared curiosity and eagerness to learn new tools and technologies has made the process both exciting and supportive.

Select/Group Insights

After reviewing the timeline, we grouped related insights into categories such as communication, task management, and technical setup. The first image, Figure 2, captures our team organizing sticky notes into swimlanes, while the second, Figure 3, shows the finalized groupings that highlighted our major themes for growth.

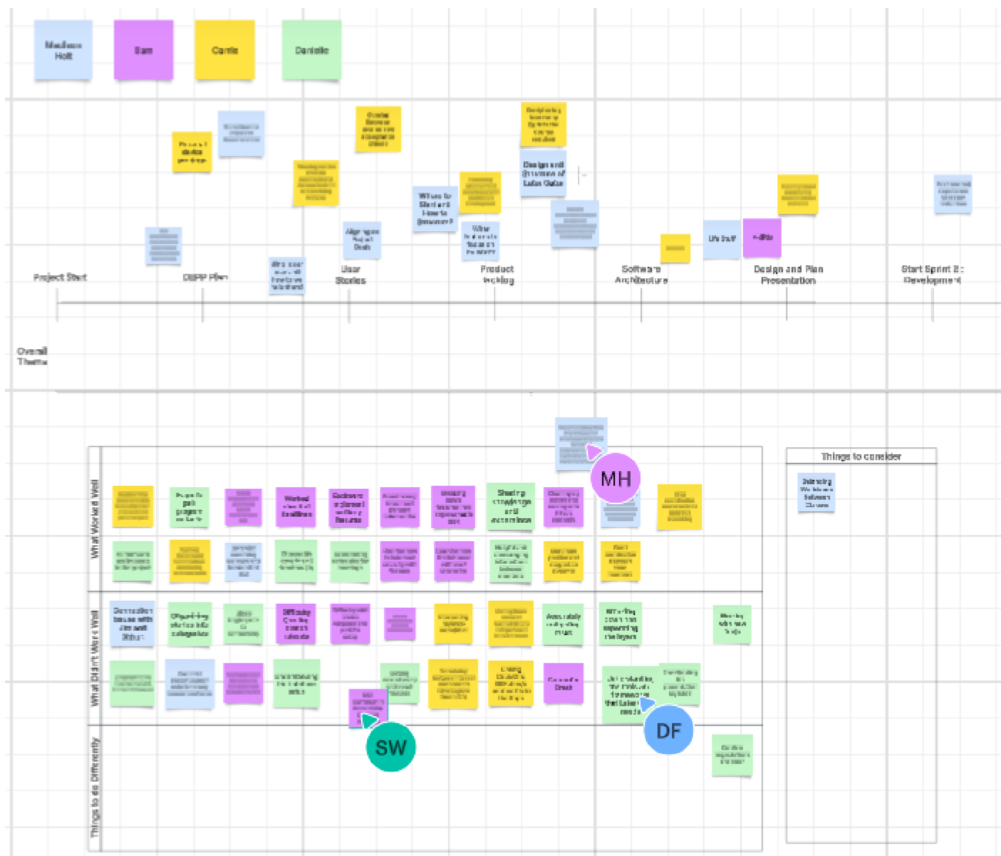

Figure 2: Team members collaboratively sorting insights into swimlanes for clearer categorization.

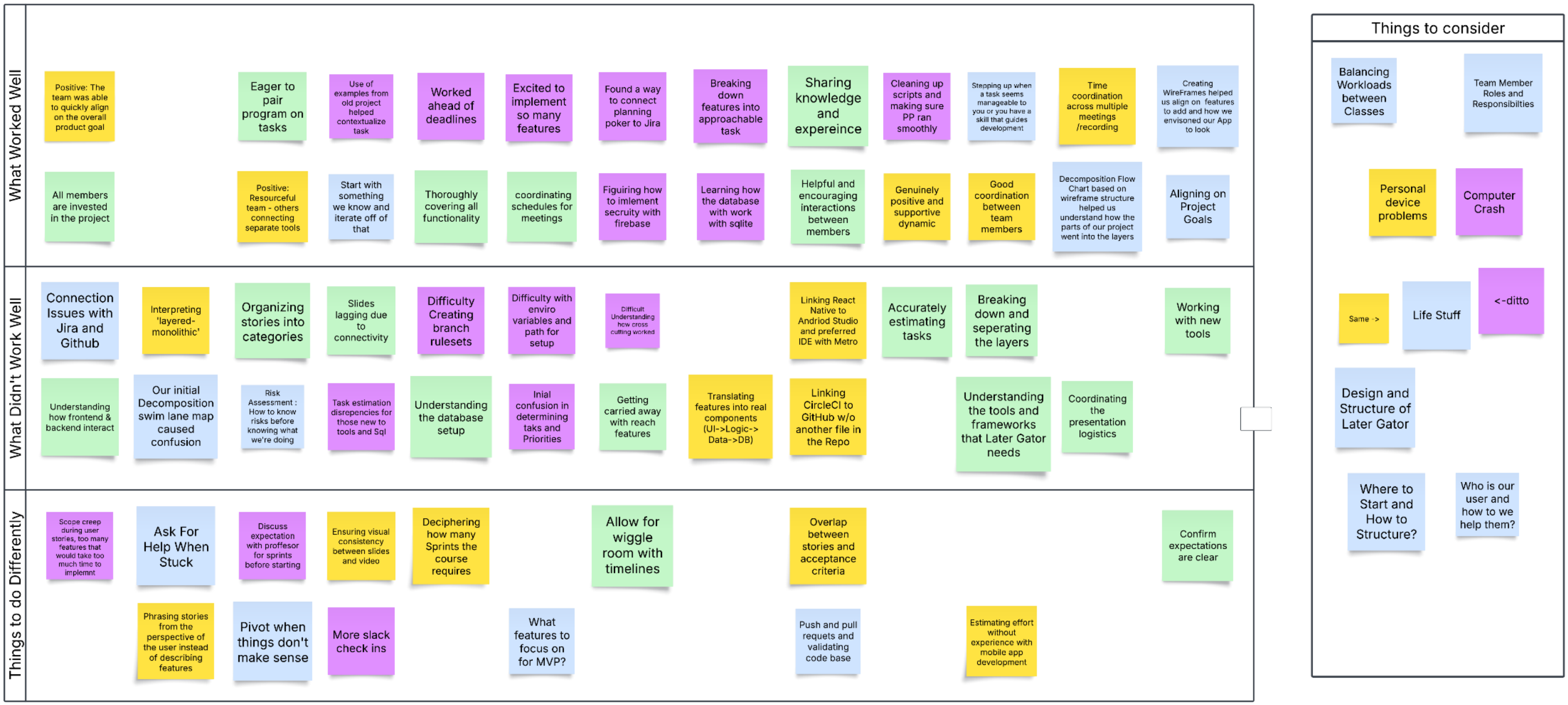

Figure 3: Final groupings of insights showing primary categories for team growth and improvement.

Vote on Insights

Each member received five votes to silently prioritize insights they felt were most impactful. This “dot voting” process ensured equal input from all members and helped us focus on the issues with the greatest consensus for improvement. Figure 4, below, shows all team member’s dots placed.

Figure 4: Team members using dot voting to prioritize insights based on collective agreement.

Decide on Actions

The team ranked all insights by number of votes and collaboratively discussed the top priorities. We then transformed those insights into concrete action items for the next sprint, ensuring that our solutions address both workflow and technical development challenges. Figure 5 shows the insights by priority, horizontally. Their vertical placement does not indicate priority.

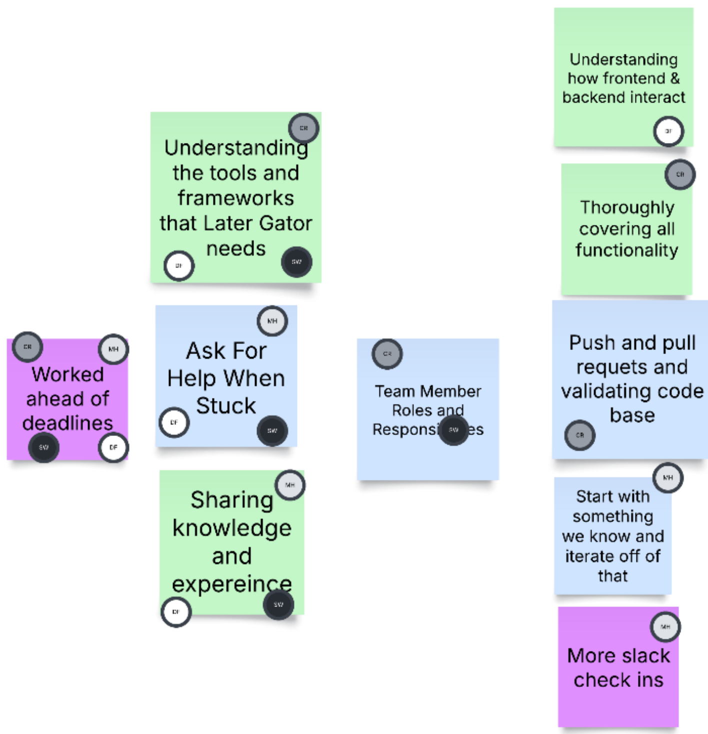

Figure 5: Insights arranged by number of votes to determine next sprint priorities and action items.

SMAR(T) Plan

Our SMAR(T) Plan outlines specific, measurable, achievable, and relevant goals with a focus on setting time-bound commitments where needed to keep the team and project aligned. While some objectives remain consistent with our previous sprint, others now include firm deadlines to ensure we stay on track for upcoming deliverables. The goals below emphasize maintaining early progress, strengthening communication, improving tool proficiency, and validating our development processes.

Worked Ahead of Deadlines

- Continue to look ahead at the calendar to see due dates.
- Work with team members to discuss individual schedules to plan team meetings on zoom and check ins on slack.
- Start assignments early in order to recognize problems and tackle them without being pressed for time.
- Create clear goals for each planned meeting, keep track in the shared Google doc.

Ask For Help When Stuck

- Identify problem areas early on and don't hesitate to ask other members for assistance in moving forward.
- Keep track of questions asked, even if they are answered quickly. Consider using the sprint retrospective template, or the shared Google doc.
- Discuss obstacles in the Daily Scrum Weekly Report.

Sharing Knowledge and Experience

- Ask questions and discuss tasks in a collaborative group environment.
- Post helpful information or things found on slack more frequently.
- Post questions and concerns on slack more frequently.
- All team members should keep the Daily Scrum Weekly Report updated.

Understanding the Tools and Frameworks that Later Gator Needs

- Research tools and frameworks and how they work together.
- By Monday Oct 27th, the team will ensure local environment links correctly with remote repo (including CircleCI).
- By Nov 7th, test cases will help verify the implementation of tools to develop features.

Team Member Roles and Responsibilities

- Pair Programmers will discuss potential dates to meet independent of the team meetings, and will lay out a rough plan to complete tasks (internal deadlines).
- Tasks in Jira are clearly assigned to members of the team.

More Slack Check-ins

- Plan slack check-ins ahead of assignment due dates each week. Check-ins should allow team members to make sure they are on the same page and bring up problems that may arise.
- Keep Pair-Programming communication relevant to a particular task in a thread (as opposed to the main team chat).

Push and Pull Requests and Validating Code Base

- By Monday, October 27th, the team will validate PRs are possible, accurate, and CircleCI is integrated in the remote repo.
- Follow product development best practices.

Start with Something We Know and Iterate Off of That

- If we run into issues and become confused on how to proceed with an assignment, we should start from something we understand or already know. This will prevent us from becoming stuck and give us a launching pad on how to proceed with an issue.
- Discuss with team members to see if they may have prior knowledge or insights with problems.

Thoroughly Covering All Functionality

- Refer back to the project plan and breakdown of components to confirm all features necessary for the minimal viable product are accounted for.
- Remain aware of the potential for scope creep by creating the test cases for each feature first.

Understanding How Frontend & Backend Interact

- By Monday Oct 27th, the team will confirm back-end functionality by running a demo.
- Team members will communicate with the other members responsible for the complementing frontend/backend task they are responsible for.
- Test cases will be developed by Nov 7th to ensure frontend and backend components are linked correctly.